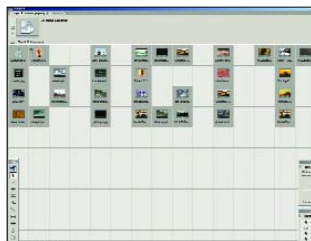


Capture..., or just press [F5]. Make sure the input device shows up on this screen.

Now, on the right, you will see two tabs—'Logging' and 'Settings'. Make sure all the options in these two tabs are set to your requirements and then capture your video.

Storyboarding

 The most important aspect of editing video, or indeed, creating movies, is storyboarding. This will give you a general idea of how your movie is going to turn out. As video editing often takes days to complete,



You can use the Project pane to drag clips and arrange them to form a rough storyboard



it will also save you from struggling to remember which clip you wanted to place where. There's no need to pull out a pencil and paper and start drawing—just use the Project pane as

your storyboard.

Set the clips to display as thumbnails and add posters as described in the previous tip. Now, just drag and arrange your clips like a storyboard. It's really that simple!

Poster It

 Quite often, you might have a large number of clips in the Project pane. The best way to view these is as thumbnails.

For this, click on the little arrow icon on the top right of the Project pane, go to View > Icon. Now, you can see all your clips as thumbnails in the Project pane. To increase or decrease the size of the thumbnails, click on the arrow again and go to Thumbnails and choose from 'Small, Medium or Large'.

Now you will have all imported clips displayed as thumbnails. However, a lot of clips may look alike, or have just a blank screen in the beginning. This can confuse you and you don't want to play every clip just to see which is which.

You can choose which frame to use as a thumbnail for a clip, also called setting a poster. In the Project pane, click on the clip you want to set a poster for, and then use

Video Editor Speak

Have you always wanted to be a video editor? Do you fancy yourself to be the next Sally Menke? To fit in, you need to understand the phrases and jargon video experts throw around:

AVI: Audio Video Interleaved. AVI files are audio-visual files that meet Microsoft's Resource Interchange File Format (RIFF).
MPEG: Motion Picture Experts Group. A compression standard for audio-visual files. MPEG-1 files are low-resolution, and are used for short movies on the web. MPEG-2 files are high-resolution videos for digital television.

JPEG/JPG: Joint Photographic Experts Group. This is an image compression standard which reduces image file sizes by deleting unnecessary data. Along with GIF, JPEG images are the most commonly used images on the web.

GIF: Graphic Interchange Format. One of the most commonly used image formats on the web. GIF images contain a maximum of 256 colours with minimal colour variations and

shading and are thus small in size. The GIF format is not used for photographic images and are better suited for logos and buttons.

Composite: Two or more layers of video. You can superimpose two or more visuals, each of which moves independently. The simplest form of composites are subtitles and credits.

Rendering: Once you finalise and want to preview your video, the software computes how you want it to appear. It calculates frames, surfaces, colours, shading, texture, etc, and creates the rasterised images that you see on your screen. This is known as rendering.

Raster: A raster image is simply a matrix of points, also called pixels, made up of data. The data tells an image viewer whether the point is to be

displayed as black white or colour. Common raster image formats are GIF, JPEG, PCX, and TIFF.

Cross-fade: Fading in of one audio or video clip while another fades out is known as cross-fade. For a brief moment,

both clips are visible or audible. This is also called dissolve.

Cut Scene: An instantaneous end of one clip or scene and the beginning of another.

Lip sync: Synchronising the audio and video tracks so that sounds are heard at exactly the same time as the video depicts. An example is the synchronisation of speech with lip movements.

Mosaic: An effect which increases the size of the pixels to give a sort of stained glass or chess board effect. It is often used to artistically blur video.

Voiceover: Like the narrator of

a story, a voice over is the voice of someone who is not in the movie.

Wipe: A transition effect that replaces one video clip with another but does so smoothly. It appears like a curtain being drawn from one side to the other.

Posterisation: The process of flattening a visual to remove all colour and brightness variations. It makes the visual look like it was painted with poster colours.

RAW: Unedited audio or video—straight from the camera.

Rough cut: This is an initial quick-edited version of a final product. A rough cut is generally used to make sure that the video follows a storyboard, and to gauge the final product.

Soundtrack: The audio portion of a video. A soundtrack contains background music, speech, voiceovers, etc. Most of us know "soundtrack" as the music and songs from a movie.

Sweetening: Enhancing the audio track by adding filters, effects and tweaking it.

